



LET'S GO HOME

TOKYO STORY / 1953

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Drama

DIRECTOR

Yasujirô Ozu

WRITERS

Kôgo Noda, Yasujirô Ozu

STARS

Chishû Ryû, Chieko Higashiyama, Sô Yamamura, Kuniko Miyaki

BEFORE

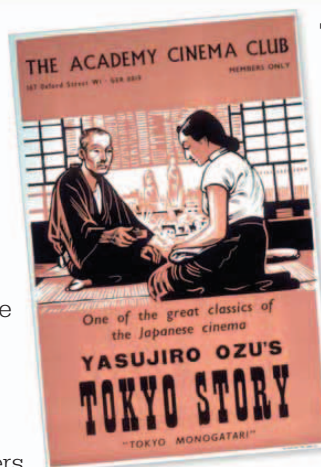
1949 The first great movie in Ozu's final period, *Late Spring*, is an example of *shomin-geki*, a story of ordinary people's lives in post-war Japan.

1951 Ozu continues his preoccupation with the state of the Japanese family with *Early Summer*.

AFTER

1959 In Ozu's *Floating Weeds*, a group of *kabuki* theater actors arrive in a seaside town, where the lead actor meets his son for the first time.

Tokyo Story was made in the wake of the decades of militarism in Japan that culminated in catastrophic defeat in World War II. Ripples from the war can be detected in it, but unlike many Japanese movies of the postwar period, Yasujirô Ozu's movie remains even-keeled throughout. Its characters go about their lives without fuss, and it ends with a quiet tragedy that mirrors Japan's somber introspection at the time.



The movie depicts Japan at a moment of profound change, but its story of familial disintegration resonated with audiences worldwide.

As the title suggests, *Tokyo Story* is a simple tale. The movie is more a carefully curated collection

of moments than a drama, and concerns relations within a family. Shukichi (Chishû Ryû) and Tomi (Chieko Higashiyama) have four

Yasujirô Ozu Director

Often described as the most Japanese of filmmakers, Yasujirô Ozu is also the most accessible of the great directors to emerge from that country in the postwar period. His unfussy style won him the reputation of a minimalist—but his movies are busy with the rich detail of human life and drama. Between 1927 and 1962, Ozu directed more than 50 features. All of

them focused in some way on the changing rhythms of family life in the modern age. His “Noriko Trilogy,” of which *Tokyo Story* was the last, all starred Setsuko Hara as Noriko.

Key movies

1949 *Late Spring*
1951 *Early Summer*
1953 *Tokyo Story*